

CATHERINE JASON

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student (3.9 GPA, AAS in Cybersecurity) working toward a Tier 1 SOC Analyst role, holding CompTIA Security+ and BCR Cyber's SOC Operations Analyst I (SOCOA I) certification. Currently supports technology and security operations for a 42-school district, managing user accounts and permissions, reviewing endpoint logs and Defender alerts, and handling remote technical support in a NIST/DoIT-aligned environment. Also provides freelance IT and security support for a small business client, and previously led a large-scale device deployment rollout across the district.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations & SIEM: Splunk log analysis and alert triage, log correlation, IOC review, incident response fundamentals

Network Security: TCP/IP, VLANs, NAT, DHCP, Cisco Catalyst switching (2950, 2960 Plus, 3560G), Cisco 4331 ISR routing, Wireshark traffic analysis and baselining

Intrusion Detection & Vulnerability Tools: SNORT, Nessus, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Hashcat, Aircrack-ng

Digital Forensics: FTK Imager, OSForensics, E3 Forensic Platform, ProDiscover, chain-of-custody documentation

Systems & Identity: Windows Server, Active Directory and Group Policy, Linux (Kali, Parrot, Ubuntu), Microsoft Intune, SCCM, Dell Command Update

Security Concepts: Access control and least privilege, authentication, cryptography basics, risk management (NIST/ISO frameworks)

PROJECTS

Honey-AI - LLM Prompt Injection Honeypot

- Built a tool that mimics a standard AI customer service chatbot to catch and log jailbreak and prompt injection attempts
- Set up the system using local LLMs through Ollama, a FastAPI backend for detection logic, and a Streamlit chat interface
- Created a dashboard to track exploitation trends and attack patterns over time

Network Infrastructure Build

- Designed and configured a segmented lab network using Cisco Catalyst switches and a 4331 ISR router, setting up VLANs, routing, NAT, and DHCP on physical hardware
- Used Wireshark to capture and baseline traffic, validating configuration changes through packet inspection and controlled test scenarios

Home SOC Lab

- Built a virtual lab (Kali Linux and Windows hosts) to simulate brute-force login attempts and port scanning activity
- Reviewed authentication logs in Splunk, correlated activity across hosts and network sources, and triaged findings to separate false positives from real events

Digital Forensics Investigation

- Performed forensic imaging and examined disk artifacts, file systems, and registry data using FTK Imager, OSForensics, E3 Forensic Platform, and ProDiscover
- Documented findings following evidence integrity and chain-of-custody practices

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technology Services Specialist

Aug 2026 to Present

Carroll County Public Schools, Westminster, MD

- Manage user accounts, permission changes, and group memberships within the district's User Management System, applying least-privilege access practices
- Review system and endpoint logs alongside Microsoft Defender alerts to support early identification of security issues
- Provide remote technical support for staff systems using Microsoft device management tools and Quick Assist
- Work within a department where security practices are aligned to NIST SP 800-53 and Maryland DoIT standards

IT Deployment Technician (Seasonal)

Summer 2026

Carroll County Public Schools, Westminster, MD

- Deployed and imaged more than 6,000 student devices and 45 staff systems across 42 school sites for the district's one-to-one rollout, completing configuration tasks independently
- Applied Windows security updates district-wide using Dell Command Update, Software Center (SCCM) for staff devices, and Company Portal (Intune) for student devices
- Executed and verified scheduled backup and restore procedures in support of disaster recovery readiness
- Managed end-of-life device transitions, including wiping, staging, and inventory auditing of retired hardware, and tracked assets by site

Independent IT and Cybersecurity Support (Freelance)

2024 to Present

Sykesville, MD

- Provide on-demand IT and cybersecurity troubleshooting for a small business client across Windows and macOS environments
- Use Quick Assist, Remote Desktop, Screen Sharing, AnyDesk, and TeamViewer to resolve account access issues, performance problems, and suspected security events
- Guide clients through remediation steps and basic endpoint hardening during live troubleshooting sessions

Preschool Teacher

2022 to 2024

Baltimore County Public Schools

- Managed a structured, high-responsibility classroom environment under time-sensitive conditions, maintaining consistent procedures and monitoring
- Communicated clearly with staff and families, often requiring calm, fast decision-making

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701), issued August 2026
- SOC Operations Analyst I (SOCOA I), BCR Cyber, issued October 2025

EDUCATION

- Associate of Applied Science in Cybersecurity, Carroll Community College, GPA 3.9 (Expected Dec 2026)
- CompTIA CertMaster Learn & Labs for Security Pro+, Carroll Community College, GPA 4.0 (Dec 2025)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Phi Theta Kappa Honor Society International, Alpha Psi Psi Chapter
- Cybersecurity Association, Inc.
- Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS)